Ellie Kuznetsova

San Diego, CA | ye.s.kuznetsova@gmail.com | LinkedIn | Website | Github

SUMMARY

Early-career AI Language Engineer with an M.S. in Computational Social Science and a background in linguistics and translation. Experienced in building multilingual NLP, LLM evaluation, and speech AI pipelines for code-switched and low-resource language data. Skilled in Python, Hugging Face Transformers, dataset creation, annotation, and experimental evaluation.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher Sep 2025 — Present
Learning, Meaning, and Natural Language Lab (PI: Alex Warstadt), UC San Diego La Jolla, CA

- Lead a Spanish–English code-switching study evaluating XLM-RoBERTa and Llama 3 on grammatical minimal pairs.
- Build an end-to-end Python pipeline comparing model surprisal (minicons) with human acceptability judgments, including preprocessing, statistical testing, and visualization.
- Direct creation of a code-switched minimal-pair dataset; supervise undergraduate research assistants in sentence generation and quality control.

Graduate Student Researcher Sep 2025 — Present
Bilingualism in Context Lab (PI: Anne Beatty-Martinez), UC San Diego La Jolla, CA

- Build Python and R pipelines to clean, restructure, and analyze repeated-reference bilingual interaction data.
- Compare multilingual sentence embeddings (SBERT, LaBSE, MPNet) using cosine similarity and t-SNE visualizations.
- Fit mixed-effects regression models to quantify convention formation and language choice across repeated interactions.

Graduate Student Researcher (Capstone) Sep 2025 — Jun 2026
Phonetics Lab (PI: Will Styler), UC San Diego La Jolla, CA

- Fine-tuned and evaluated a transformer-based ZIPA speech model for zero-shot keyword search in Tira, an unseen low-resource language.
- Developed Python pipelines for training, inference, and evaluation; validated audio transcriptions to improve data reliability.

Graduate Researcher Apr 2022 — Present
Northern Arizona University Flagstaff, AZ

- Built the Writing Feedback Corpus (WFC) for open-access release; led study design and task delegation, annotated and coded data, and reviewed research assistants' work for quality control.
- Co-authored two manuscripts submitted to *Applied Corpus Linguistics* and *CALICO Journal*; co-authoring a participant recruitment chapter for the LANA-CASE corpus manual (Applied Linguistics Press, in preparation).

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Translation Intern, InReach (Remote) Sep 2023 — Dec 2023

- Post-edited 20,000+ machine-translated strings in Crowdin and localized English–Russian platform content for 420,000+ users.

Fake News Detection Classifier, Course Project, UC San Diego Jun 2026

- Built a text classifier to detect fake news in a four-person team; presented results at a poster session.

SKILLS

Programming: Python, R, SQL, LaTeX
NLP & Models: Hugging Face Transformers, LLM evaluation, surprisal analysis, sentence embeddings, keyword spotting, speech models; XLM-RoBERTa, Llama 3, SBERT, LaBSE, MPNet, ZIPA
ML & Statistics: fine-tuning, inference, classification, regression, mixed-effects modeling, t-SNE, cross-validation
Libraries: pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, PyTorch, minicons, sentence-transformers, matplotlib, tidyverse, lme4
Research & Tools: corpus construction, annotation & coding, human judgment data collection; Git, Jupyter, Praat, ELAN, Qualtrics, Crowdin
Languages: Russian, English, French, American Sign Language

EDUCATION

M.S. Computational Social Science, University of California San Diego Jun 2026
Computational Social Science Excellence Award ($16,000)
M.A. Applied Linguistics and Teaching English as a Second Language, Northern Arizona University May 2023
B.A. Linguistics, Pushkin Leningrad State University Jul 2019

**All sections contain selected information; a complete list is available upon request.*